



1738

NADIR SHAH INVADES MUGHAL INDIA

After conquering Kandahar in Afghanistan, the Persian ruler Nadir Shah invaded Mughal India, then already under pressure from the Sikhs and Hindu Marathas. At the Battle of Karnal (1739), he defeated a larger Mughal force and captured their ruler, Muhammad Shah. He plundered Delhi, carrying away treasure – including the Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor diamond – worth 700 million rupees. The plunder meant Nadir could continue his campaigns against the Ottoman Empire and in the North Caucasus.

◀ Battle of Karnal fresco

“If the names are unknown, knowledge of the things also perishes.”

CARL LINNAEUS, PHILOSOPHIA
BOTANICA, 1751

1739 The Russo-Turkish war ends; Russia abandons its claims to Crimea but gains a Black Sea port at Azov

1739

1735 The French begin establishing sugar plantations in Indian Ocean islands



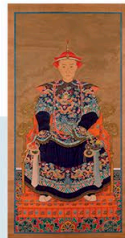
△ The Capture of Puerto Bello

1739

WAR OF JENKINS' EAR BEGINS

War broke out when Britain was goaded into action over the case of Robert Jenkins – a captain whose ear was cut off by Spanish coastguards attempting to curb illicit trade in their New World colonies. Britain attacked Spanish possessions, capturing Puerto Bello naval base in Panama, and fighting continued until 1748, when it was subsumed by the War of the Austrian Succession.

1735-96
QIANLONG
CHINA



In his 60-year reign, the Qianlong Emperor (1711-99) developed China into a vast, multi-ethnic empire, whose diversity he celebrated.

1735 Qianlong becomes emperor, succeeding the Yongzheng Emperor, and announces a reign of liberal magnanimity.

1750 The emperor gains renown as a poet, calligrapher, and patron of literature, commissioning works to glorify Manchu culture and history.

1755 Qianlong begins the Ten Great Campaigns that expand the Qing Empire to its greatest extent, albeit at huge financial cost.

1770 Qianlong assembles a great collection of art at his summer palace, including his own writings as shown on this vase (above).